

Online Information

- "Living in a connected world means that there is a lot of information available for individuals to find".
- "However, it can be difficult to find good quality information".
- "When you find quality information, it is important that you know how to use it appropriately".
- "Getting information off the Internet is like taking a drink from a fire hydrant" – Mitchell Kapor.

Information Sources

- **Primary source:** "something that you have created yourself".
- **Secondary source:** "something that has been created by someone else".
- **Primary Examples:**
 - "Photographs that you have taken yourself".
 - "Interviews or questionnaires conducted by you".
 - "Your own blogs, social media posts or emails".
 - "Your own sound or video recordings".
- **Secondary Examples:**
 - "Newspapers, books and maps".
 - "CDs, DVDs or Blu-rays created by others".
 - "Television and radio broadcasts".
 - "Websites created by other people".

Search Engines & Operation

- "Search engines compare the words entered by a user with words in a database of web pages".
- "They then show the user the results that are the closest match to their original keywords".
- **Keywords:** "the words or search terms that a user types into a search engine in order to look for matching information".
- **Autofill:** "the automatic suggestion of a completed word or phrase that is provided as the user types".
- **Browsing history:** "the URLs that an individual user has visited, which are stored in a file".

Search Syntax Rules

- **Syntax:** "the rules that describe how words and phrases are used in a language".
- **AND (+):** "Adding + between words will return only results that match both words".
- **NOT (-):** "Adding - before a word will return only results that do not include that word".

- **Phrase matching (""):** "Placing speech marks around a group of words will return only results that include the whole phrase with the words in that specific order".
- **Usage rights:** "the way in which a piece of information is permitted to be used".

Evaluating Information

- **Fitness for purpose:** "whether the information is suitable or good enough for the intended use".
- **Accuracy checks:**
 - "Checking that the information is from a trustworthy source that has good systems for checking facts before publication".
 - "Comparing it against other trustworthy sources".
 - "Seeing if the information uses evidence to support its claims".
- **Age checks:**
 - "Checking the publication date".
- **Relevance checks:**
 - **Relevance:** "whether the information relates directly to what you want to know".
 - "Checking that the information's topic matches the topic for which you intend to use it".
- **Reliability checks:**
 - "Comparing it against other unrelated sources to see if it matches".
- **Bias checks:**
 - **Bias:** "unfairly favouring one point of view, or not considering other points of view".
 - "Checking to see if it provides a range of viewpoints".
 - "Considering whether you could use the same information to tell a story from a different perspective".

Plagiarism & Paraphrasing

- "The internet has made information easily available to many people".
 - "However, this means that it is becoming more common for people to copy and paste information, sometimes without even checking that it is suitable or true".
 - **Plagiarism:** "using someone else's work and pretending it is yours".
 - **Paraphrasing:** "expressing what someone else has said in a shorter, clearer or different way".
 - "If you use another person's work but fail to state that it is theirs and not yours, you are violating their rights and committing plagiarism".
 - "If you do this in your assignments for school, college or university, you will be punished and your marks could be reduced or you could fail the assignment completely".
 - "One way to avoid plagiarism is to rewrite or paraphrase information".
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CHAPTER QUESTIONS

1. Which one of these is used to match a full phrase in a search? (1)
 - a. +
 - b. -
 - c. @
 - d. ""
2. State two ways in which an image search can be refined. (2)
3. State one reason why you should check whether information is biased before using it. (1)
4. Describe how a search engine works. (4)
5. Explain why it is important to check whether information is protected by copyright before using it in your own work. (2)
6. State one benefit to students of rewriting information rather than copying it word-for-word. (1)
7. State three examples of search syntax. (3)
8. Complete Table 10.3 by stating whether each source is primary or secondary. (8)

SOURCE	PRIMARY OR SECONDARY?
A podcast that you have created	
A video of a discussion that you have with an expert	
Your own copy of a film	
Notes that you take while visiting a museum	
A book that you borrow from someone	
An image that you download from the internet	
Your own recording of a radio broadcast	